Apps Script Web App Guide

Beginner prompts for school admin and clerical tools.

How to use this digital handout:
This version focuses on **Google Apps Script web apps**. A web app is a simple website you can build with Apps Script. It can show HTML pages, forms, buttons, dashboards, charts, modals, and admin panels while reading from or writing to Google Sheets, Docs, Drive, Gmail, Calendar, and Forms.

The Beginner Web App Prompt Formula

"I am a beginner using Google Apps Script. Build a web app for [**school workflow**]. The web app should have [**pages or features**]. It should use [**Google Sheet/Form/Doc/Calendar/Drive folder**] as the data source. When a user [**clicks/submits/searches/filters**], it should [**result**]. Give me the Apps Script files, HTML files, setup steps, deployment steps, and testing steps in beginner-friendly language."

What To Include When Prompting AI

Web app purpose	What office, admin, student support, or clerical workflow should it improve?
Pages needed	Dashboard, form, graph page, search page, admin page, confirmation page, help page.
Data source	Which Google Sheet, Form response sheet, Doc template, Calendar, or Drive folder is involved?
User actions	Submit, search, filter, approve, deny, upload, create, send, schedule, export.
Outputs	Emails, drafts, calendar events, generated Docs, charts, status updates, logs, shared files.
Safety	Preview first, use sample data, create drafts before sending, log actions, require authorized users.

The Feature Pages

Each page after this gives a flexible prompt, a plain-English explanation, setup notes, and real school use cases. The pages are intentionally modular so you can mix features together into larger web apps.

Apps Script Web App Shell

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a basic Google Apps Script web app with an HTML home page.

What it does

This is the starting structure for a web app. It usually includes an Apps Script file that serves the page and one or more HTML files that users see in the browser.

How to set it up

Ask AI for a simple `doGet` web app structure, an `index.html` file, and deployment steps. Ask it to explain how to deploy as a web app and how to open the web app URL.

School use cases

- A front office request portal.
- A student support dashboard for administrators.
- A family intake or resource request page.
- A staff-only tool for reports, emails, calendars, or document generation.

What to include in your prompt

- The purpose of the web app.
- Who will use it.
- Which Google tools it should connect to.
- What the first page should show.
- Whether users must be signed in with a school Google account.

Web App Navigation

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create navigation for a multi-page Apps Script web app.

What it does

Navigation lets users move between pages such as Home, Dashboard, Submit Request, Graphs, Reports, Admin, and Help. It makes the web app feel organized instead of like one long page.

How to set it up

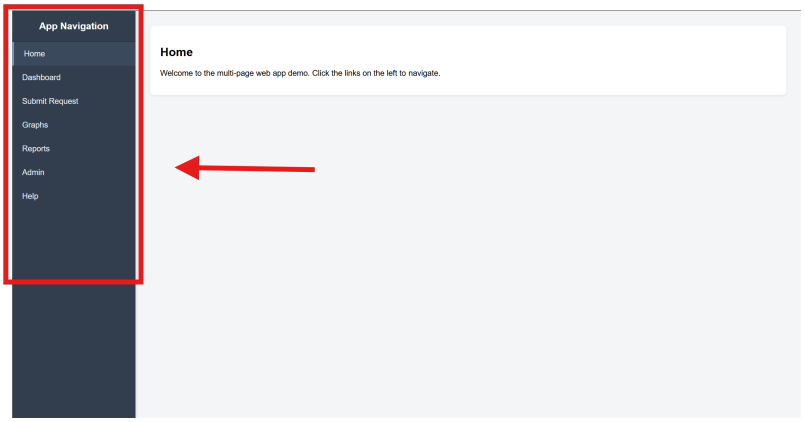
Ask AI to create a navigation bar or side menu in the HTML. For a simple beginner version, each navigation item can show or hide a section on the same page. For a larger version, AI can create multiple HTML templates.

School use cases

- A student support portal with Dashboard, Student Search, Interventions, and Reports.
- A clerical office portal with Requests, Calendar, Documents, and Logs.
- A behavior system with Submit Incident, Review Incidents, Graphs, and Admin Settings.
- A staff resource hub with Forms, Links, Help, and Contact Tools.

What to include in your prompt

- The page names users need.
- Whether navigation should be top tabs, side menu, or buttons.
- Which page should open first.
- Whether some pages should be admin-only.
- Whether it should work well on phones and laptops.



Example image: web app navigation sidebar

HTML Intake Form

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create an HTML form inside an Apps Script web app.

What it does

An HTML form lets users submit information from a web page instead of typing directly into a Sheet. The form can save responses to a Sheet and trigger next steps such as email, calendar, or document creation.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create the HTML form fields and a server-side Apps Script function that writes the submission to a Google Sheet. The prompt should say which fields are required and what confirmation the user should see after submitting.

School use cases

- Behavior incident collection form for staff.
- Parent contact log form for teachers or office staff.
- Counseling, tech, facilities, or supply request form.
- Enrollment, document request, or transportation update form.

What to include in your prompt

- The exact fields the form should collect.
- Which fields are required.
- Which Sheet tab should store responses.
- What should happen after submission.
- Whether the submitter should receive a confirmation email.

Modal Window in a Web App

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a modal window inside the HTML page of your Apps Script web app.

What it does

In a web app, a modal is a pop-up panel inside the HTML page. It can show details, confirmations, edit forms, warnings, or help without sending the user to a new page. The same idea can also exist in Google Sheets as an Apps Script dialog, but for web apps it usually means HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

How to set it up

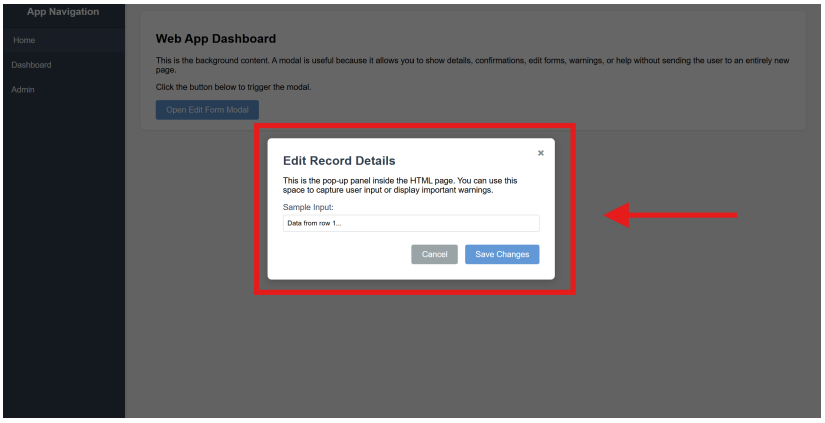
Ask AI to create the modal in the HTML page, style it with CSS, and use JavaScript to open and close it. If the modal saves information, ask AI to connect it to Apps Script with `google.script.run`.

School use cases

- Open a student detail pop-up from a dashboard table.
- Confirm before sending emails to families or staff.
- Edit the status of a request without leaving the dashboard.
- Show help text, definitions, or next-step guidance.

What to include in your prompt

- What opens the modal.
- What information the modal should show.
- Whether the modal is view-only or editable.
- What buttons it should include.
- What should happen when the user clicks Save, Cancel, Confirm, or Close.



Example image: modal window inside a web app

Confirmation and Success Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a confirmation message or success page after a user submits a web app form.

What it does

A confirmation page reassures the user that their submission worked. It can show what was submitted, what happens next, and who to contact if there is a problem.

How to set it up

Ask AI to show a success message after the server function finishes saving data. For more detail, ask it to display a confirmation number, timestamp, next steps, or a button to submit another request.

School use cases

- Staff request submitted successfully.
- Parent contact logged successfully.
- Behavior incident received by the admin team.
- Calendar appointment created or document request received.

What to include in your prompt

- What message the user should see.
- Whether to show a timestamp or confirmation ID.
- Whether to summarize the submission.
- What next-step instructions should appear.
- Whether the user should get an email confirmation too.

Required Fields and Form Validation

Tell AI this: Tell AI to add required fields and friendly validation messages to a web app form.

What it does

Validation checks whether users filled out the form correctly before the tool saves data or runs an action. It prevents incomplete requests, missing email addresses, invalid dates, and confusing submissions.

How to set it up

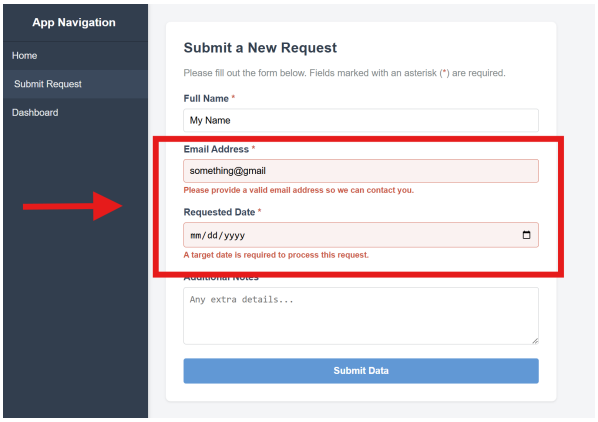
Ask AI to validate in the HTML page before submission and again in Apps Script before writing to the Sheet. Ask for friendly messages that tell users what to fix.

School use cases

- Preventing blank student names or missing IDs.
- Checking that email addresses look valid.
- Requiring a reason before a request can be submitted.
- Making sure appointment start and end times make sense.

What to include in your prompt

- Which fields are required.
- What counts as a valid answer.
- What message users should see when something is missing.
- Whether invalid fields should be highlighted.
- Whether the Submit button should be disabled until the form is complete.



Example image: required fields and validation messages

KPI Cards

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create KPI cards for an Apps Script web app dashboard.

What it does

KPI cards are big summary numbers on a dashboard. They help users quickly see what needs attention without reading a full spreadsheet.

How to set it up

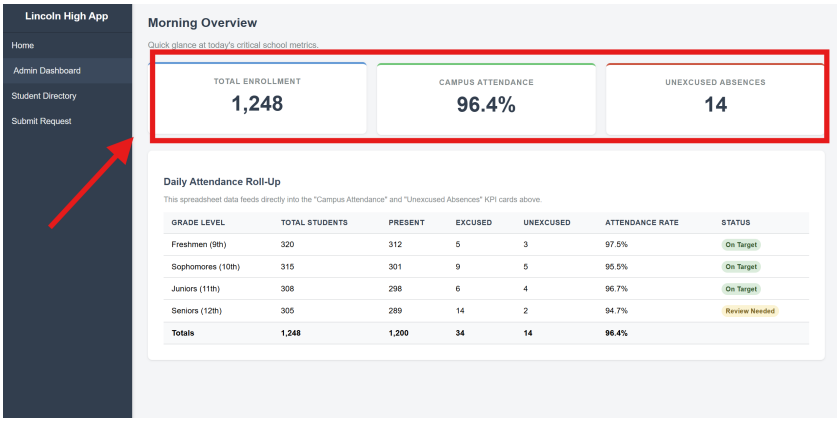
Ask AI to calculate KPI values from a Google Sheet and display them as cards in the HTML page. The cards can refresh when the page loads or when a user clicks a Refresh button.

School use cases

- Total open behavior referrals.
- Students with attendance below a threshold.
- Overdue intervention follow-ups.
- Pending office requests, missing forms, or incomplete records.

What to include in your prompt

- Which KPIs should appear.
- Which Sheet tab contains the data.
- How each KPI should be calculated.
- Whether KPIs should be filtered by date, grade, staff member, or status.
- What color or label should signal urgency.



Example image: dashboard KPI cards

Dashboard Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a dashboard page for an Apps Script web app.

What it does

A dashboard page combines KPI cards, charts, tables, filters, and action buttons. It gives administrators and office staff a single place to monitor a workflow.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a web app dashboard that reads from a Google Sheet. Tell it which summaries, filters, charts, and tables should appear. Ask for beginner-friendly labels so users know what each number means.

School use cases

- Daily attendance monitoring dashboard.
- Behavior referral review dashboard.
- Intervention or student support dashboard.
- Front office request, records, or enrollment dashboard.

What to include in your prompt

- The workflow the dashboard supports.
- The data source tab.
- KPIs, charts, and tables needed.
- Filters users need.
- What actions users should be able to take from the dashboard.

Chart.js Graphs

Tell AI this: Tell AI to add Chart.js graphs to an Apps Script web app dashboard.

What it does

Chart.js can create bar charts, line charts, pie charts, and doughnut charts inside an HTML web app. It helps users see patterns faster than reading rows of data.

How to set it up

Ask AI to load Chart.js from an HTTPS CDN and pass summarized data from Apps Script into the chart. If your district blocks external scripts, ask AI to provide a simple table or CSS-only fallback.

School use cases

- Referrals by month, grade, location, or incident type.
- Attendance trends by week.
- Requests completed versus pending.
- Intervention outcomes by status or staff member.

What to include in your prompt

- What type of graph you want.
- What question the graph should answer.
- Which Sheet columns provide labels and values.
- Whether users should filter the graph.
- Whether the graph should show counts, percentages, or trends.

Graphs and Reports Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a separate Graphs or Reports page in the web app.

What it does

A reports page gives users a place to explore charts, summaries, and printable views without crowding the main dashboard. It can be organized by month, grade, department, category, or status.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a separate navigation page for graphs and summaries. The page can include multiple Chart.js charts, tables, date filters, and a print-friendly report section.

School use cases

- Monthly behavior summary for leadership meetings.
- Attendance trend report for grade-level teams.
- Office request completion report.
- Intervention progress report for counselors or administrators.

What to include in your prompt

- Which reports users need.
- Which graphs should be on the page.
- What filters should be available.
- Whether the page should be printable.
- Whether the report should include explanations or notes.

Filterable Data Table

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a searchable and filterable data table in the web app.

What it does

A data table lets users view spreadsheet records in a cleaner web page. Filters and search boxes help users find the rows that matter without editing the raw data.

How to set it up

Ask AI to read rows from a Google Sheet and display them in an HTML table. Include search, filters, sorting, and clear empty-state messages when no records match.

School use cases

- Search behavior incidents by student, date, grade, or status.
- Filter office requests by pending, completed, or assigned staff.
- Review intervention logs by student or follow-up date.
- Find missing enrollment documents or incomplete records.

What to include in your prompt

- Which columns should appear.
- Which filters users need.
- Whether users can sort columns.
- Whether clicking a row should open details in a modal.
- Whether some columns should be hidden from certain users.

Search Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a search page for finding a student, staff member, request, or record.

What it does

A search page helps users quickly find one record from many rows. It is useful when the web app is connected to a roster, contact log, request tracker, or intervention database.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a search box, search button, and results area. The Apps Script function should search the Sheet and return matching records to the HTML page.

School use cases

- Student lookup for attendance, behavior, or support notes.
- Family contact lookup for front office staff.
- Request ID search for clerical workflows.
- Staff assignment search for tasks or follow-ups.

What to include in your prompt

- What users can search by.
- Which columns should be searched.
- What results should display.
- What should happen when no match is found.
- Whether clicking a result should open a detail page or modal.

Student or Record Detail Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a detail page or detail modal for one selected record.

What it does

A detail view shows one record clearly instead of forcing users to read across many spreadsheet columns. It can display summary information, notes, history, and action buttons.

How to set it up

Ask AI to open details when a user clicks a table row or search result. For web apps, this can be a separate page, a section on the same page, or a modal window.

School use cases

- Student profile with attendance, behavior, interventions, and contacts.
- Request details with submitted information, assigned staff, and status history.
- Parent contact details with notes and next follow-up.
- Document request details for enrollment or records teams.

What to include in your prompt

- Which record type users will view.
- What fields should appear in the detail view.
- Whether users can edit anything.
- What action buttons should appear.
- Whether sensitive details should be hidden for some users.

Status Update Buttons

Tell AI this: Tell AI to add buttons that update the status of a Sheet row from the web app.

What it does

Status buttons let users move work forward from the web app. Instead of editing a spreadsheet cell, they click buttons such as Mark Complete, Assign, Approve, Deny, Follow Up, or Archive.

How to set it up

Ask AI to connect each button to a server-side Apps Script function that updates the correct row in the Sheet. Ask for a confirmation message and an action log entry after the update.

School use cases

- Mark office requests as pending, in progress, or complete.
- Assign behavior referrals to an administrator.
- Mark intervention follow-ups as completed.
- Update records requests after documents are received.

What to include in your prompt

- What statuses are allowed.
- Which buttons users need.
- Which Sheet column stores the status.
- Whether a note or timestamp should be added.
- Whether users should confirm before changing the status.

Approval Workflow

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create an approval page with Approve and Deny buttons.

What it does

An approval workflow helps staff submit requests and lets an authorized person review them. The web app can show pending items, capture decisions, update the Sheet, and notify the submitter.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a pending requests table and action buttons. The approval action should update the Sheet, record who approved or denied it, and optionally send an email update.

School use cases

- Staff supply or professional learning requests.
- Field trip, coverage, or facility requests.
- Student support resource requests.
- Records, enrollment, or schedule change approvals.

What to include in your prompt

- What users can submit for approval.
- Who can approve or deny.
- What information reviewers need to see.
- What happens after approval or denial.
- Whether the submitter should receive an email.

Email After Web App Submission

Tell AI this: Tell AI to send an email after a user submits a web app form.

What it does

This sends a confirmation, alert, or follow-up message after a web app action. It is similar to Form submission email, but the submission happens on your custom HTML page.

How to set it up

Ask AI to save the submission first, then send the email. For sensitive communication, ask AI to create a preview or draft before sending live emails.

School use cases

- Confirmation after a staff request is submitted.
- Notification to an administrator after a behavior incident is logged.
- Family or staff follow-up after a meeting note is submitted.
- Reminder to assigned staff after a task is created.

What to include in your prompt

- Who receives the email.
- What the subject should say.
- Which submitted fields should appear in the email.
- Whether the email should send immediately or create a draft.
- Whether the email action should be logged.

Email Preview or Draft Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create an email preview page before anything is sent.

What it does

An email preview page lets users review the message before sending. The user can see the recipient, subject, and body, then choose Create Draft or Send. This is clearer for beginners because it describes the actual action.

How to set it up

Ask AI to show a preview area after the user selects a record or submits a form. The safer beginner option is to create Gmail drafts first.

School use cases

- Preview parent communication before sending.
- Review staff reminders generated from overdue tasks.
- Check a behavior or attendance alert before emailing.
- Create drafts for a principal, counselor, or office lead to review.

What to include in your prompt

- What message should be previewed.
- Whether users can edit the message before sending.
- Whether the default action should be Create Draft.
- Who is allowed to send live emails.
- What should be logged after a draft or email is created.

Calendar Event Creator

Tell AI this: Tell AI to let users create Calendar events from the web app.

What it does

This feature creates Google Calendar events from form submissions, selected records, or table rows. It saves clerical time when scheduling meetings, conferences, and follow-ups.

How to set it up

Ask AI to collect event title, date, start time, end time, description, location, and guests. The Apps Script function should create the event and save the event status back to the Sheet.

School use cases

- Parent conference scheduling.
- Intervention follow-up meetings.
- Student support team meetings.
- Office appointments for records, enrollment, or testing.

What to include in your prompt

- Which Calendar should receive the event.
- What fields users enter.
- Whether guests should be invited.
- Whether the event should be created from an existing row.
- What confirmation users should see after scheduling.

Document Generator

Tell AI this: Tell AI to generate Google Docs from a template through the web app.

What it does

A document generator copies a Google Doc template and replaces placeholders such as `{{StudentName}}`, `{{MeetingDate}}`, `{{GuardianName}}`, or `{{NextStep}}` with data from a form or Sheet row.

How to set it up

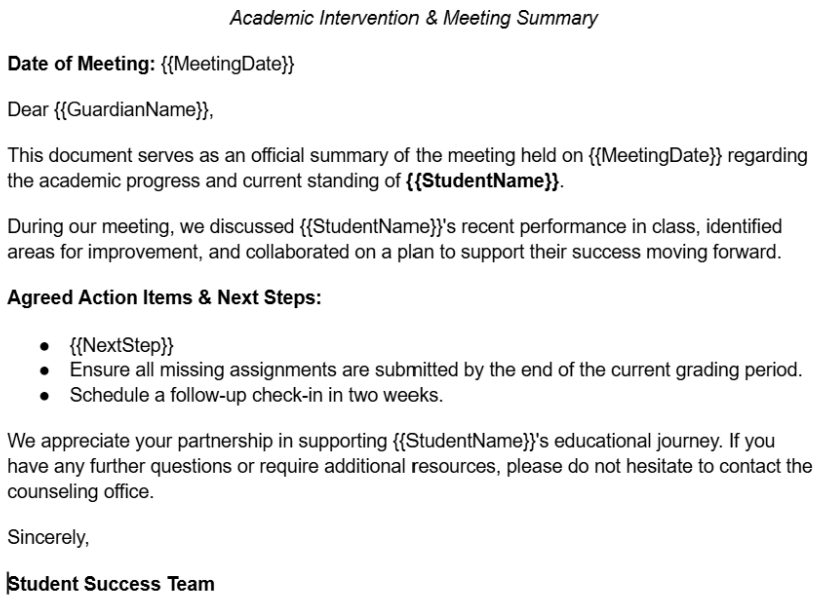
Create the template first, then type placeholders wherever personalized information should go. Ask AI to map each placeholder to a web app form field or Sheet column, copy the template, replace the placeholders, save the new Doc in Drive, and return a link.

School use cases

Student support plans, meeting summaries, award certificates, recognition letters, attendance notices, behavior notices, intervention notices, enrollment letters, and family communication.

What to include in your prompt

- Which template Doc and Drive folder to use.
- The exact placeholders in the template, such as `{{StudentName}}` or `{{Date}}`.
- Where the replacement data comes from.
- Whether the Doc should be shared, emailed, or simply linked.



Academic Intervention & Meeting Summary

Date of Meeting: {{MeetingDate}}

Dear {{GuardianName}},

This document serves as an official summary of the meeting held on {{MeetingDate}} regarding the academic progress and current standing of **{{StudentName}}**.

During our meeting, we discussed {{StudentName}}'s recent performance in class, identified areas for improvement, and collaborated on a plan to support their success moving forward.

Agreed Action Items & Next Steps:

- {{NextStep}}
- Ensure all missing assignments are submitted by the end of the current grading period.
- Schedule a follow-up check-in in two weeks.

We appreciate your partnership in supporting {{StudentName}}'s educational journey. If you have any further questions or require additional resources, please do not hesitate to contact the counseling office.

Sincerely,

Student Success Team

File Upload to Drive

Tell AI this: Tell AI to add a file upload feature to the Apps Script web app and save uploads to Google Drive.

What it does

A file upload page lets users submit documents through the web app. This can support records collection, enrollment documents, permission slips, photos, or forms that need to be attached to a request.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create an HTML file input and an Apps Script function that saves the uploaded file to a specific Drive folder. Ask for file naming rules and a Sheet log of uploaded files.

School use cases

- Families or staff uploading documents for enrollment or records.
- Staff attaching issue photos or supporting files to tech requests.
- Uploading signed forms or permission slips.
- Collecting evidence or attachments for an office workflow.

What to include in your prompt

- What types of files are allowed.
- Where files should be saved in Drive.
- How files should be named.
- Whether upload links should be saved in a Sheet.
- Who should be allowed to upload.

Share Docs or Folders

Tell AI this: Tell AI to share Google Drive files or folders from the web app.

What it does

Automatic sharing gives the right person access to the right file without manually changing Drive permissions. The web app can share generated documents, resource folders, or uploaded files.

How to set it up

Ask AI to use viewer, commenter, or editor access intentionally. For school data, ask it to log who received access and when.

School use cases

- Share a generated meeting summary with assigned staff.
- Share onboarding or department folders with new staff.
- Share requested resources after a web app submission.
- Share student support documents with authorized team members.

What to include in your prompt

- Which file or folder should be shared.
- Who should receive access.
- What permission level they should get.
- Whether an email notification should be sent.
- Whether sharing should be recorded in an action log.

Role-Based Pages

Tell AI this: Tell AI to show different web app pages or buttons based on the user's email or role.

What it does

Role-based pages make the same web app useful for different people. A staff member might submit requests, while an administrator sees dashboards, approvals, reports, and settings.

How to set it up

Ask AI to check the signed-in user's email and compare it to an Authorized Users or Roles tab. Also ask AI to explain web app deployment settings, because user identity depends on how the web app is deployed.

School use cases

- Teachers see a Submit Request page; administrators see Review and Reports.
- Office staff see records tools; leadership sees dashboards.
- Counselors see student support tools; general staff see only intake forms.
- A principal has Send Email access while others can only create drafts.

What to include in your prompt

- What roles exist.
- Which emails belong to each role.
- Which pages or buttons each role can see.
- What unauthorized users should see.
- Whether denied access should be logged.

Simple Email-List Access

Tell AI this: Tell AI to limit access by checking whether the user's email appears in column A of an Authorized Users spreadsheet.

What it does

This is a beginner-friendly way to control who can use a web app. The web app checks the signed-in user's email, looks for that email in a Google Sheet, and only continues if the email is approved.

How to set it up

Create a Google Sheet tab called Authorized Users. Put approved emails in column A. Ask AI to check the active user's email, compare it to that list, and show a friendly access denied page if the email is not found. This works best inside a school domain where users are signed in with their school Google account.

School use cases

- Staff-only dashboards with student support or behavior data.
- Admin-only approval pages.
- Office tools that send emails, share files, or update records.
- Web apps where teachers submit requests but only office staff process them.

What to include in your prompt

- The spreadsheet ID or tab name that stores approved emails.
- Whether column A contains only emails or also names and roles.
- What users should see if they are not approved.
- Whether denied access attempts should be logged.
- Whether different roles should unlock different pages or buttons.

Deployment and Sharing Settings

Tell AI this: Tell AI to explain the Apps Script web app deployment settings and recommend the safest sharing option for a school workflow.

What it does

Deployment settings decide who can open the web app and whose permissions the app uses when it runs. These choices matter because school tools may touch student data, staff data, email, Drive files, Calendars, or records.

How to set it up

Ask AI to walk you through **Deploy > New deployment > Web app**. It should explain options such as executing as the owner versus the user accessing the app, and who has access to the deployed URL. For school use, domain-only sharing is usually safer than public link sharing when the app contains student or staff information.

School use cases

- Share a staff request portal only with your school or district domain.
- Deploy an admin dashboard so only signed-in school users can access it.
- Test a web app with a small group before sharing it widely.
- Avoid exposing student information through an "anyone with the link" setup.

What to include in your prompt

- Who needs access: only you, specific testers, your domain, or anyone with the link.
- Whether the app handles FERPA-protected or sensitive data.
- Whether users should sign in with school Google accounts.
- Ask AI for a testing checklist before broad sharing.
- If you must use anyone-with-link access, ask AI how to prevent data leaks and test many edge cases first.

Settings Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create an admin settings page for the web app.

What it does

A settings page lets authorized users update options without editing code. This is helpful for emails, categories, routing lists, thresholds, links, and dashboard settings.

How to set it up

Ask AI to store settings in a Google Sheet tab. The web app should read those settings when it runs and only allow authorized users to edit them.

School use cases

- Update routing emails for behavior, counseling, tech, and facilities requests.
- Change attendance or intervention thresholds.
- Edit dashboard categories or status labels.
- Maintain staff lists, grade levels, departments, or school year settings.

What to include in your prompt

- Which settings should be editable.
- Where settings should be stored.
- Who can access the settings page.
- Whether changes should be logged.
- What validation is needed before saving settings.

Action Log and Audit Trail

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create an action log for the web app.

What it does

An action log records what happened in the web app. It helps users troubleshoot, verify communication, and answer accountability questions.

How to set it up

Ask AI to write log entries to a Sheet tab. Each entry can include timestamp, user email, action, record ID, result, and error message if something failed.

School use cases

- Track who approved or denied a request.
- Record when emails, drafts, Docs, or Calendar events were created.
- Log student support status changes.
- Troubleshoot missing notifications or failed submissions.

What to include in your prompt

- Which actions should be logged.
- What information each log row should include.
- Whether errors and successful actions should both be logged.
- Whether users should see a log page in the web app.
- Whether old logs should be archived.

Friendly Error and Success Messages

Tell AI this: Tell AI to add clear success and error messages to the web app.

What it does

Messages help users understand what happened. A good web app should not fail silently or show confusing technical errors to beginners.

How to set it up

Ask AI to show user-friendly messages in the HTML page and write technical errors to a log. Use plain language like “Your request was saved” or “Please enter a valid email address.”

School use cases

- Let users know a form saved successfully.
- Explain when a required field is missing.
- Show a clear message if an email or Calendar event fails.
- Tell users what to do next after a document is generated.

What to include in your prompt

- What success message users should see.
- What common errors should be handled.
- Whether errors should be logged for admins.
- Whether users should retry, edit, or contact someone.
- What language will make sense to non-technical staff.

Help Page or Guided Instructions

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a Help page or guided instructions inside the web app.

What it does

A Help page makes the web app easier to use without separate training. It can explain the workflow, define statuses, show examples, and answer common questions.

How to set it up

Ask AI to add a Help page to the navigation. Keep it written for brand-new users, with short steps and plain language.

School use cases

- Explain how staff submit a behavior or support request.
- Define dashboard numbers and status labels.
- Show clerical staff how to process requests.
- Provide a quick reference for office workflows.

What to include in your prompt

- What users most often need help with.
- Which terms or statuses need definitions.
- Whether example images or short walkthroughs should be added later.
- Whether help should be a page, modal, or tooltip.
- Who to contact for support.

Mobile-Friendly Layout

Tell AI this: Tell AI to make the Apps Script web app mobile-friendly.

What it does

Many staff will open tools from a phone, tablet, Chromebook, or laptop. A mobile-friendly layout keeps forms, buttons, dashboards, and tables readable on smaller screens.

How to set it up

Ask AI to use responsive HTML and CSS. For tables, ask it to stack fields, reduce columns, or show cards on mobile.

School use cases

- Staff submitting behavior or tech requests from a hallway or classroom.
- Administrators checking dashboard summaries on a phone.
- Office staff using a tablet at a check-in desk.
- Families opening a web app from a QR code.

What to include in your prompt

- Which devices users are likely to use.
- Which pages must be easy on a phone.
- Whether tables should become cards on mobile.
- How large buttons should be.
- Whether the app should avoid tiny text or crowded columns.

QR Code Launch Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to design the web app so it can be opened from a QR code.

What it does

Once deployed, a web app has a URL. That URL can be turned into a QR code so staff, students, or families can quickly open a request form, check-in page, or resource portal.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a clean landing page that makes sense when someone opens it from a QR code. The QR code itself can be generated outside the script, but the web app should have a simple first screen.

School use cases

- Staff scan a QR code to submit a hallway behavior note.
- Families scan a QR code at registration to request records or resources.
- Students scan a check-in QR code for counseling or tutoring.
- Staff scan a QR code to report tech or facilities issues.

What to include in your prompt

- Who will scan the QR code.
- What page should open first.
- Whether users must sign in.
- What instructions should appear at the top.
- Whether the page should work well on phones.

Appointment or Sign-Up Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a sign-up or appointment page in the web app.

What it does

A sign-up page lets users choose a slot, session, or appointment. The web app can save the selection, prevent overbooking, send confirmations, and optionally create Calendar events.

How to set it up

Ask AI to read available slots from a Sheet and mark slots as taken when users submit. If Calendar is involved, ask it to create events after the slot is confirmed.

School use cases

- Parent conference sign-ups.
- Enrollment or records appointments.
- Staff professional learning session sign-ups.
- Student support check-in appointments.

What to include in your prompt

- What slots are available.
- How many people can sign up per slot.
- What information users must enter.
- Whether confirmations or Calendar events should be created.
- What should happen when a slot is full.

Data Quality Review Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a web app page that checks data quality in a Google Sheet.

What it does

A data quality page helps clerical and administrative staff find problems before they create bigger workflow issues. It can flag blanks, duplicates, invalid emails, missing IDs, and inconsistent statuses.

How to set it up

Ask AI to scan a Sheet, summarize issues, and show a table of records needing correction. For a safer beginner version, ask it to highlight issues without changing data automatically.

School use cases

- Missing guardian emails or student IDs.
- Duplicate records in an enrollment or contact list.
- Incomplete request submissions.
- Invalid dates, statuses, or staff assignments.

What to include in your prompt

- Which fields are required.
- What errors the page should detect.
- Whether issues should be highlighted in the Sheet.
- Whether users can mark issues resolved.
- Whether a summary email should be sent to office staff.

Printable Report Page

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a print-friendly report page in the web app.

What it does

A print-friendly page formats web app information for meetings, records, or PDF printing. It removes clutter and focuses on the report content.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a report section with clean formatting and a Print button. If PDF generation is needed, ask AI whether the report should be printed from the browser or generated as a Google Doc first.

School use cases

- Weekly behavior summary for leadership.
- Attendance concern list for grade-level meetings.
- Intervention follow-up report for counselors.
- Office request status report for clerical teams.

What to include in your prompt

- What report users need.
- What filters should apply before printing.
- What columns or charts should appear.
- Whether the report should include date and school name.
- Whether it should print from browser or generate a Doc.

You Are Not Limited to Web Apps

Tell AI this: Tell AI that web apps are the focus, but you also want ideas for Apps Script tools inside Gmail, Sheets, Docs, Forms, Calendar, and Drive.

What it does

Apps Script web apps are powerful, but they are only one option. Apps Script can also add menus, sidebars, dialogs, triggers, email tools, document generators, Calendar automations, and Drive workflows directly inside Google Workspace tools.

How to set it up

Ask AI whether your workflow should be a web app or a tool attached to an existing Google file. If users already live inside a Sheet, a Sheet menu or sidebar may be easier. If the workflow starts with a Form, a Form submit trigger may be enough. If the workflow is mostly communication, Gmail drafts may be better than a full web app.

School use cases

- A Google Sheet with an `onOpen` menu for office staff.
- A Gmail draft generator connected to a parent contact Sheet.
- A Form submit trigger that emails the right staff member.
- A Docs template generator for letters, certificates, or meeting notes.
- A Calendar automation that schedules meetings from Sheet rows.

What to include in your prompt

- Where users already do the work.
- Whether the workflow needs a full web page or just a menu/button.
- Whether the tool should run automatically, on form submit, on a schedule, or when clicked.
- Which Google app should be extended.
- Whether users need a dashboard, a form, a document, an email, or a calendar event.

Spreadsheet Menus, Sidebars, and Dialogs

Tell AI this: Tell AI to build a Google Sheets tool with an `onOpen` menu, sidebar, or dialog instead of a full web app.

What it does

A Sheet-based tool is best when the spreadsheet is already the main workspace. Users can click a custom menu, open a sidebar, or use a dialog while staying inside the Sheet.

How to set it up

Ask AI to create a container-bound Apps Script attached to the Sheet. It can add a custom `onOpen` menu, show a sidebar with `HTMLService`, or open a dialog. This is different from a deployed web app because users access it from inside the Sheet.

School use cases

- Intervention tracker with Refresh Dashboard and Create Drafts menu items.
- Behavior log with a sidebar for student details and status updates.
- Attendance tracker with a dialog for adding notes or follow-up actions.
- Data cleanup Sheet that checks blanks, duplicates, and invalid emails.

What to include in your prompt

- Whether you want a menu, sidebar, dialog, or button.
- What the user should click.
- What data the tool should read or update.
- Whether the tool should create drafts, send emails, refresh dashboards, or log actions.
- Whether certain menu items should be admin-only.

Gmail, Calendar, Docs, and Forms Automations

Tell AI this: Tell AI to create a non-web-app automation that works directly with Gmail, Calendar, Docs, Forms, or Drive.

What it does

Some workflows do not need a web app. A simple trigger or script can send a confirmation email, create a Calendar event, generate a Doc, share a file, or process Form responses automatically.

How to set it up

Ask AI where the script should live: attached to a Sheet, attached to a Form, or standalone. Then ask for the trigger setup. Common trigger choices include form submit, time-driven schedule, and menu click.

School use cases

- Send an email when a Google Form is submitted.
- Create Calendar events from Sheet rows.
- Generate personalized Docs from a template.
- Share a Drive folder after a staff or family submission.
- Create Gmail drafts from a Sheet for review before sending.

What to include in your prompt

- Which Google app starts the workflow.
- What trigger should run the script.
- Which data should be used.
- What output should be created.
- Whether the script should preview, draft, log, or confirm before final action.

Quick checklists for stronger prompts

Web App Prompt Checklist

Purpose	What real school workflow should this web app improve?
Users	Who will use it: admin, clerical staff, counselors, teachers, families, or students?
Pages	What pages are needed: dashboard, form, graphs, reports, search, settings, help?
Data	What Google Sheet, Form response sheet, Doc template, Calendar, or Drive folder is involved?
Actions	What can users do: submit, search, filter, approve, email, schedule, generate, upload?

Dashboard and Graph Prompt Checklist

Question	What school question should the dashboard answer?
KPIs	What summary numbers should appear at the top?
Charts	What graphs are needed: bar, line, pie, doughnut, trend, comparison?
Filters	Should users filter by date, grade, teacher, status, category, or student group?
Actions	What should users be able to do from the dashboard?

Safer Beginner Prompt Add-Ons

Use sample data first	Create drafts before sending emails	Show a preview before final action
Add friendly error messages	Log important actions	Explain every setup step
Tell me exactly what files to create	Make it mobile-friendly	Protect student information